

CORRIDOR OPPORTUNITY FINDER

Find corridors where a new business format may be worth exploring.

BEGINNER → INTERMEDIATE

DATA + LOGIC

OPTIONAL: MAP / LLM / MCP

THE IDEA

Imagine a café brand wants to open a new outlet. Instead of checking every corridor manually, it wants a shortlist of places that look promising - and a simple explanation of why.

THE QUESTION TO SOLVE

“Which corridors should we investigate first for a chosen café format?”

The goal is not to predict success. The goal is to turn several pieces of information into a useful shortlist for further investigation.

WHAT THE DATA GIVES YOU

- Corridors: named commercial districts. The dataset covers 65 corridors in New York City and 72 in Dallas–Fort Worth.
- Business fit: how well a café format appears to fit a corridor. Fit is represented using a score and labels such as STRONG_FIT, MODERATE_FIT and WEAK_FIT.
- Whitespace: a signal suggesting potential room or opportunity for cafés.
- Existing places: counts of places such as cafés, grocery stores, schools, hospitals, event venues and more.
- Audience and context: who is associated with the corridor, when activity is stronger, and what makes the corridor distinctive.

THE MINDSET

You are not given the answer. You are given clues. Your job is to combine the clues into a useful decision.

1. THE PROBLEM

Looking at only one number can be misleading. A corridor may have strong café fit but already have many cafés. Another may have fewer cafés but a weaker fit for the type of café you want.

Corridor	What you know	Question to ask
A	Strong café fit	Is there still room to explore?
B	Few existing cafés	Does the format fit the corridor?
C	Good fit + favorable whitespace signal	Is it worth investigating first?

2. START WITH ONE SIMPLE QUESTION

START HERE

“Which corridors look promising for a café?”

Once the first version works, make the question more specific:

- Which corridors look promising for a neighborhood café?
- Which corridors look promising for a café aimed at morning commuters?
- Which corridors have strong café fit and a favorable opportunity signal?

3. A SIMPLE WAY TO THINK ABOUT IT

Choose a format	Check fit	Check opportunity	Check existing cafés	Rank	Show why
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The first version can be ordinary programming: read the JSON, compare values, rank the corridors and display the result. You do not need machine learning to make the basic idea useful.

4. WHAT SHOULD THE RESULT LOOK LIKE?

Corridor	Why it stands out
Corridor A	Strong fit + favorable opportunity signal + manageable existing café supply
Corridor B	Strong fit + a useful audience/context combination
Corridor C	Higher opportunity signal but weaker fit - worth comparing

The examples above are illustrative. Your actual values should come from the provided dataset.

5. WHICH PARTS OF THE DATA CAN HELP?

Business fit

Think: “Does this type of café seem suitable for this corridor?” The dataset gives a score and a fit label for each corridor + business format.

Example: Fit score / tier

Whitespace

A signal about potential opportunity for cafés. It can help you compare corridors, but it is not a literal count of empty shops.

Example: behavior.whitespace_quality.cafe

Existing cafés

Count the café listings represented in the corridor. This gives a simple picture of existing café presence.

Example: places.classes.CAFE.listing_count

Audience

Look at who is associated with the corridor. The data includes groups such as morning commuters, family households, office routines and study groups.

Example: Audience scores

Context

Use daypart activity, corridor character, anchors and other place types to explain the result.

Example: Corridor context

IMPORTANT

Whitespace is an expert supply/demand judgment, not measured market saturation. Treat it as a signal, not a guarantee.

6. YOU DO NOT NEED EVERYTHING

Start with two or three signals. Once your first ranking works, add another layer. This is usually better than trying to understand the entire dataset at once.

Fit	Whitespace	Existing cafés
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Then you can add audience, timing, anchors or a map.

7. ONE POSSIBLE RANKING

EXAMPLE ONLY

Opportunity = fit + whitespace - an existing-supply penalty

This is only one possible method. You could instead use simple rules, thresholds, separate rankings, or your own weighting. The important part is being able to explain why one corridor ranked above another.

8. BUILD A SMALL VERSION FIRST

LEVEL 1 / BEGINNER

Read the JSON → filter corridors → compare values → rank → show a table
Use Python, JavaScript or another language you know.

LEVEL 2 / INTERMEDIATE

Add filters, charts, a map, corridor detail pages or better explanations
Turn the shortlist into an easy-to-use interface.

LEVEL 3 / ADVANCED

Let a user ask a question in plain English and use an LLM + MCP to fetch and explain the relevant data
MCP = a standard way for an AI model to use tools or data sources.

9. WHERE COULD MCP FIT?

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a way for an AI model to use tools or data sources in a structured way. For this example, it could sit between the user's question and the corridor data.

User asks	LLM understands	MCP gets data	Your logic compares	Answer + evidence
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Possible small tools might be:

- search corridors
- get a corridor
- get fit information
- get places
- get audience information

REMEMBER

MCP is the bridge. The useful product is the answer the user gets from the data.

10. A GOOD FINAL RESULT

A strong version should answer three things quickly:

- Which corridors should I look at?
- What signals made them interesting?
- What should I investigate next?

11. THINK FROM THE USER'S DECISION

The most important step is not choosing a technology. It is deciding what your user needs to know.

USER	A business or analyst exploring a new café location
DECISION	Which corridors are worth investigating first?
EVIDENCE	Fit + whitespace + existing cafés + audience/context
OUTPUT	A ranked shortlist with clear reasons

12. POSSIBLE EXTENSIONS

- Let the user choose different café formats.
- Add an audience filter, such as “show corridors where morning commuters are important.”
- Add a map and let users click a corridor for more detail.
- Show the signals behind each ranking so the result is explainable.
- Add an AI-generated explanation for “Why did this corridor rank highly?”
- Compare two corridors side by side.

13. WHAT NOT TO CLAIM

AVOID

“This is a guaranteed good location.”

PREFER

“This corridor shows a strong combination of signals and may be worth investigating further.”

14. YOUR CHALLENGE

BUILD THIS IDEA IN YOUR OWN WAY

Create a small tool that answers:

“Which corridors appear to be promising opportunities for a chosen café format, and why?”

You decide which signals to use, how to rank them, what the interface looks like, and how far you want to take it.

15. FINAL TAKEAWAY

QUESTION → DATA → SIMPLE LOGIC → USEFUL ANSWER

Start with one useful answer. Then build from there.